Scaling Customer Acquisition

Acquire - The Application

dossier

HOW TIKTOK SMART+ & GMV MAX DRIVES NEW CUSTOMER GROWTH



Presenter: Minko Ma



What Is Dossier?

Founded in 2019: A fragrance brand making luxury-inspired perfumes more accessible.

Affordable Luxury: Offers high-quality fragrances inspired by iconic designer scents at a fraction of the price.

Digital-First Growth: Leverages e-commerce, TikTok Shop, and affiliate marketing to reach and engage consumers.

Source: Dossier Official Website; TikTok for Business (2026).

The Business Challenge

Scaling Customer Acquisition Amid Diminishing Returns



01

EARLY TRACTION

Dossier gained strong initial traction on TikTok Shop through advertising and creator partnerships.

02

DIMINISHING RETURNS

Despite early success, its existing TikTok advertising approach began delivering weaker returns.

03

GROWTH OBJECTIVE

Reach more new buyers and improve conversion efficiency while meeting ROI goals.

The Strategic Question

How can Dossier acquire more new customers without sacrificing ROI?

Source: TikTok for Business, Dossier Case Study (2026).

Four TikTok Tools



How Dossier built its acquisition engine inside TikTok.

1. Smart +

Autopilot for ads.
You give it ads and a goal.
TikTok's AI picks who sees them and which ad runs.

How Dossier used it:
To reach people who had never heard of Dossier. Got 20% of the GMV Max budget.

2. GMV Max

A salesperson for your TikTok store.
It pushes all your product videos, even creators', to get the most sales per dollar.

How Dossier used it:
To sell in TikTok Shop. One campaign per product, 200+ videos each, for over a year.

3. Spark Ads

Boosting a post.
Pay to show an already popular TikTok post to more people. Likes and comments stay.

How Dossier used it:
Its 6 to 10 best posts became the ads Smart+ ran.

4. Market Scope

The report card.
Shows who saw you, who is interested, and who bought, on your site and in TikTok Shop.

How Dossier used it:
To check if adding Smart+ really brought in new buyers, on web and in TikTok Shop.

Source: TikTok for Business, Dossier Case Study; TikTok for Business, Ads Solutions.

How it all connect?

MEASURE Market Scope. One view of web conversions and Shop GMV.

Smart+ | Find new buyers.
Budget: 20% of GMV Max spend.

GMV Max | Convert shoppers.
One campaign per product.

FUEL

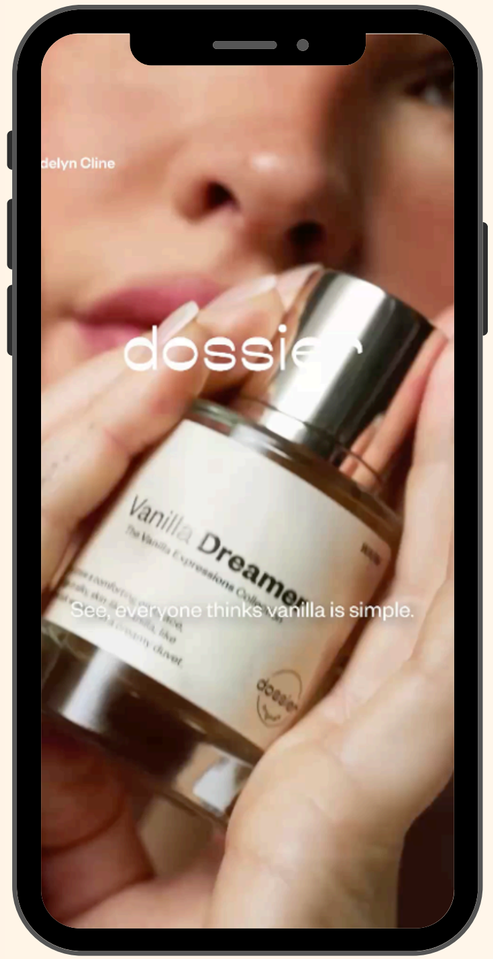
- Spark Ads: 6 to 10 proven posts to Smart+
- 200+ creatives per product to GMV Max
- Creator affiliates to GMV Max

TAKEAWAY | Different AI, different fuel. A few proven posts to win new audiences. Hundreds of variations to let the algorithm test.



Source: TikTok for Business, Dossier case study (2026).

Customer Experience: Understanding a Fragrance Online





With 200+ creatives per product, Dossier could deliver diverse fragrance content tailored to different audiences.

1. Relevant Discovery

different variation can help shoppers discover fragrance content that matches their interests.

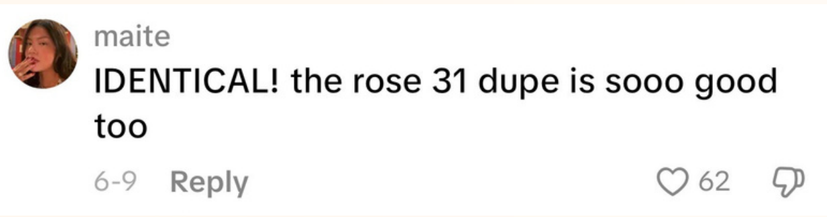
2. Informed Decision

Spark ads reetain likes, comments and shares that help shoppers evaluate

3. Less Friction

Stronger creatives receive more exposure and in-app purchase





Potential value: *A more interactive shopping experience to help customers evaluate Dossier's fragrances*

Source: TikTok for Business, Dossier Case Study (2026); TikTok for Business, Spark Ads.

Turning Reach into Results

More New Buyers, Stronger Conversion, Greater Buyer Value



Customer Acquisition

12.42%

New Buyer Rate

↑ **311%** vs. previous GMV Max-only campaigns

Pairing Smart+ with GMV Max significantly expanded Dossier's ability to acquire new buyers.

Conversion Efficiency

16.83%

Conversion Rate

↑ **362%** vs. previous GMV Max-only campaigns

The combined approach converted more reached users into customers more efficiently.

Buyer Value

$72

↑ 52%

Average Revenue per Buyer

The increase suggests Dossier attracted higher-value buyers, improving acquisition quality.

The Business Takeaway

Smart+ + GMV Max strengthened both the scale and quality of Dossier's customer acquisition.

Source: TikTok for Business. "Dossier: Formulating Higher Conversion Rates with Smart+ and GMV Max." 2026.



Proving the Business Case



FINANCIAL RETURN

9x ROI

Smart+ alone delivered strong returns, showing that Dossier could expand acquisition while maintaining profitability.

SCALING POTENTIAL

30%

Dossier saw the potential to scale Smart+ profitability by another 30%, supporting further investment.

The Business Takeaway

The results demonstrated Smart+'s potential as a profitable and scalable acquisition strategy for Dossier.

Source: TikTok for Business. "Dossier: Formulating Higher Conversion Rates with Smart+ and GMV Max." 2026.



Critical Evaluation



WHAT WORKED WELL

01 HUMAN-CURATED, AI-SCALED

Smart+ ran Dossier's 6 to 10 best organic posts, so the AI scaled creative audiences already loved.

02 TEST, DON'T OVERHAUL

Only 20% of the GMV Max budget moved to Smart+. A contained pilot still returned 9x ROI.

03 THE "CAN'T SMELL IT" GAP

Creator demos plus in-app checkout moved shoppers from curious to bought (16.83% conversion).

LIMITATIONS & RISKS

01 BLACK-BOX LEARNING

AI chooses audience, placement and creative. Results rose, but the "why" stays inside TikTok.

02 TIKTOK GRADES ITS OWN

TikTok built the tool, measured it and wrote the case. No baselines, no ROI definition, no holdout.

03 STOPS AT THE FIRST PURCHASE

No repeat rate, LTV or CAC reported, and 200+ creatives per product is a costly treadmill.

Lessons for Other Brands





Feed the Machine

Treat organic posts as your creative lab, then let paid automation scale the proven winners.



Pilot Before You Pivot

Start with about 20% of budget, set an ROI floor up front, and scale only once lift is proven.



Verify Outside the Platform

Pair platform lift studies with your own holdout tests, first-party data or MMM.



Own What Comes Next

Move new buyers into owned channels (email, loyalty, DTC) and track repeat rate and LTV.







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THANK YOU



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